



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Ref:	067	Author:	D Bibby	Date:	08.02.2024
Topic:	VEHICLE WHEELS AND TYRES				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Responsibilities for Wheel & Tyre Security and Safety

As a Driver of a commercial vehicle you have a legal responsibility to ensure that the vehicle you use on the public highway is free from visible defects. You are legally required to report any defects that you have identified in writing.

As part of their pre-use checks, drivers should always carry out an inspection of the vehicle wheels for security and safety.

Drivers should check wheels for:

- signs of damage to nuts, studs etc.
- cracked wheels, nuts, washers etc.
- distorted rims
- elongation of stud holes
- missing, broken or loose fixings/components
- signs of wheel looseness
- bright metal in the area of nut and washer seating
- rust that can be seen radiating out from the area of the nut and washer
- the position of wheel nut indicator devices (if fitted), which can indicate if wheel nuts have moved
- blocked ventilation holes
- wheel nuts should be lightly tapped with a hammer to check for looseness.

The potential consequences of not carrying out these checks thoroughly are immense, including the safety of yourself and other road users.

Not conducting the checks accordingly may lead to disciplinary action.

It is equally as important to carry out checks on your vehicle tyres. You should check:

- that all tyres are correctly inflated and that there are no obvious flat spots
- that there are no deep cuts in the tyre's sidewall
- that there is no Cord visible anywhere on the tyres

If you have any doubts about any procedure, please speak to the Workshop Manager or a Workshop Fitter, who will advise and assist.

Discussion Points

What is the minimum depth tread for HGV tyres?

What sanctions are there for a unroadworthy tyre?

What is the time/distance for when to re-torquing a wheel nut when replaced?